

# Google Photos Discovery Engine

AI Discovery

## HOW THE ENGINE WAS BUILT: 5 STEPS FROM COLLECTING DATA TO GENERATING INSIGHTS



### Types of users identified

**Object searchers** **50%**  
Quick visual tags like "dog", "car", "flower". High intent, exact matches.  
498 empty searches, 102 of 655 flooded

**Memory keepers** **35%**  
Contextual, event-driven moments: "camping trip", "that cozy dinner".  
Library floods once results appear.

**Document seekers**  
Functional visual notes: "receipt", "passport", "wifi password".

### Where memory and search disconnect

**● Struggle to retrieve**  
Older photos lost in deep archives; users scroll through thousands.

**● Actually remember**  
Faces, scenes, location and the custom notes they wrote themselves.

**● Have forgotten**  
Upload dates, original devices, file names and folder paths.

**● Formulate searches**  
Layered tags: names, locations, notes and rough date ranges.

### What to build: top pain points

**● Library flood** **102 reviews (9%)**  
**Build:** multi-faceted filters by date, location, album, person, type.

**● Wrong memories** **44 reviews (4%)**  
**Build:** memory rules set by users, with a preview before auto-generation.

**● Wrong photo** **11 reviews (1%)**  
**Build:** feedback to mark irrelevant results, plus ranking confidence.

**● Lost follow-up** **6 reviews (1%)**  
**Build:** show active search context edit or clear before a follow-up.